parties and structures was not an option for our participants when answering the question of political engagement. Again hardly anyone mentioned political institutions in their responses; political activity is reduced to the passive act of watching TV and having an opinion (and possibly discussing it with someone else). This problem was linked to a lack of trust and belief in the possibility of change through political action: '*No, there would be no point as I could bring no change*' (Student, Female, Lahore); '*No, because it is of no use. Corruption is so evident here nothing can be done here*' (Student, Female, Lahore); '*No. Because politics is all about removing someone and getting their place. Welfare of people is not given any priority*' (Student, Female, Lahore); '*No, kyon keh iss ka koi faida nahi. Agar aisi jamaat ya rehnuma mila jo mulk aur kaum keh saath mukhliss ho tu zaroor shamooliyat ikhtiyaar ki jai gi*'[32] (Academic, Female**,** Lahore). This lack of political activism on the part of the academic community was also evident with male academics, with one dismissing political activism on the basis of having 'a different field', where the underlying assumption was that only students and faculty of political fields would get involved with such idle pursuits as political activism. For others watching the news or having dinner table conversations with family amounted to a form of political activism.

Gender and Islam in the case of an all-female university in Punjab was considered a reason as to why women would not be politically active, as indicative in the quote at the beginning of this chapter. This was also reflected in the one female graduate madrassa that was visited. In one class of forty-seven female students in the university studying biochemistry, only three were willing to join politics, while the general sentiment was that women should not go into politics since it was not allowed in Islam. The discussion that ensued included examples of female leaders such as the Mughal ruler Razia Sultana and the Pakistani prime minister Benazir Bhutto but the class predominantly believed that they were wrong in running for political office. '*While women could become heads of businesses*, "*running a country*", "*becoming the leader of a nation*", "*the head of a state*" *was* "*not allowed in Islam*"'. Given the way religion has been used within schools to create the submissive subject, it also reinforced a gendered notion of the politically inactive youth. The narrative in this class of forty-seven students became particularly problematic when the argument given for why Islam did not allow women to be state leaders was given as *'auratoon ki psyche*',[33] the fact that psychologically and biologically they were not equipped to lead and hence could not be politically active. After all, as some students argued none of the Caliphs of Islam were female, thereby illustrating that it was not allowed in Islam. In the same university, in the biotechnology class the students also